

Why Open Software?

At the end of this book, you might just be still thinking open source is some kind of fad or underground movement. If you are, here's an excellent paper for you to read, which debunks the myth that proprietary software is 'superior' or a 'safer alternative.' Of course, the paper is opinionated, because it has an agenda, but it's a good read nevertheless. Mind you, though well organised, it's long! We'd rather not present it here because of the sheer number of hyperlinks that augment the article.

Find the paper *Why Open Source Software / Free Software (OSS/FS, FLOSS, or FOSS)? Look at the Numbers!* by David Wheeler at www.dwheeler.com/oss_fs_why.html. From the page:

'This paper provides quantitative data that, in many cases, using open source software / free software (abbreviated as OSS/FS, FLOSS, or FOSS) is a reasonable or even superior approach to using their proprietary competition according to various measures. This paper's goal is to show that you should consider using OSS/FS when acquiring software. This paper examines market share, reliability, performance, scalability, security, and total cost of ownership. It also has sections on non-quantitative issues, unnecessary fears, OSS/FS on the desktop, usage reports, governments and OSS/FS, other sites providing related information, and ends with some conclusions. An appendix gives more background information about OSS/FS.'

www.osdir.com

OSDir.com's tagline is 'Stable, open source apps,' and it describes itself as 'Open Source and Linux News & Software.' There is stuff about open source in general and Linux in particular, but even if you're not interested in Linux, there's a lot here that you might be interested in.

The tabs at the top include News, Forums, Open Source Software Directory, and Screenshot Gallery.